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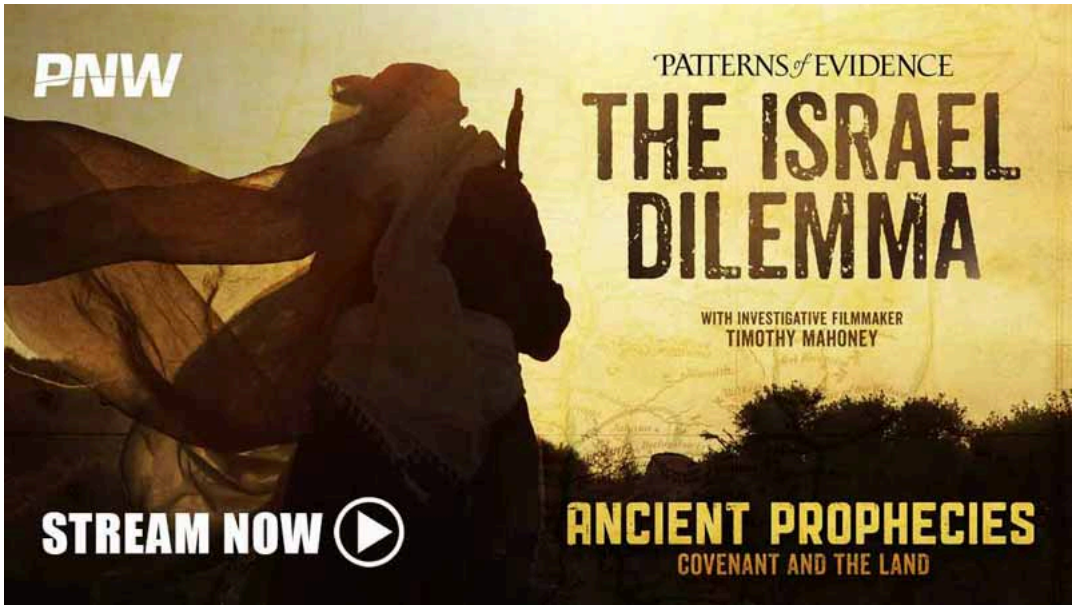

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ARTICLE

Colorado's War On Truth: Democrats Move To Punish Christian Counselors

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BY PNW STAFF MARCH 26, 2026

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What is unfolding in the state of Colorado is not simply another policy fight over LGBT issues. It is a direct test of whether the state can tell counselors--especially Christian counselors--what they are allowed to say, what they are forbidden to say, and which worldview must govern the therapy room. If that principle stands, then freedom of conscience in counseling is no longer freedom at all. It is state-managed speech with a rainbow sticker on top.

At the center of the fight is Chiles v. Salazar, a Supreme Court case challenging Colorado's law that bars licensed counselors from helping minors pursue goals such as reducing unwanted same-sex attraction or seeking alignment with their biological sex, even if that is what the client is requesting. Oral arguments were heard in October 2025, and the Court's questions suggested real concern over whether Colorado's law is engaging in viewpoint discrimination rather than merely regulating professional conduct. A ruling is expected by June 2026.

That matters because therapy--especially talk therapy--is not a surgery, not a prescription, and not a physical procedure. It is speech. It is conversation. It is counsel. If the state can punish a counselor for saying, "You do not have to identify this way," while permitting another counselor to say, "You should affirm and pursue this identity," then Colorado is not regulating therapy neutrally. It is enforcing ideology.

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And now, before the Supreme Court has even ruled, Colorado Democrats are trying to build a backup weapon.

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Think about what that means in plain English: if Colorado loses at the Supreme Court on direct censorship, lawmakers appear ready to shift to lawfare and intimidation. If they cannot silence counselors outright, they can make it financially and professionally suicidal to offer anything except LGBT affirmation.

That is not tolerance. That is not compassion. That is not "care." That is coercion.

And Christians should be especially clear-eyed about what is happening. This is not merely about one niche legal dispute or one counselor in Colorado Springs. It is about whether biblical convictions are allowed to exist in professional life unless they first bow to the sexual orthodoxy of the modern Left.

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For years now, activists have tried to frame every disagreement as "harm." If a Christian parent says sex is biological, that is "harm." If a pastor says repentance is possible, that is "harm." If a counselor helps a young person who says, "I do not want to go down this road," that too is "harm." But the truly revealing part is this: the same activists who insist identity is deeply personal and self-determined suddenly become authoritarian the moment someone wants to move away from the identity categories they celebrate.

That contradiction exposes the real agenda.

If sexuality and gender are truly matters of personal autonomy, then people must also be free to question them, reject them, or seek help living differently. Freedom only for one direction is not freedom. It is indoctrination with a legal enforcement mechanism attached.

Now, to be clear, genuine abuse in counseling should never be defended. Coercion, humiliation, manipulation, or degrading treatment has no place in any ethical counseling setting. If someone is being threatened, bullied, or psychologically brutalized, that is wrong. Full stop.

But that is not the issue at the heart of this case.

The issue is whether a client--often with parental support, often from a Christian background, often sincerely distressed--has the right to seek counseling consistent with his or her values, faith, and goals. And whether a counselor has the constitutional right to provide that help without the state acting like a doctrinal referee.

A government that can force a counselor to affirm what she believes is false is a government that has already decided truth is subordinate to politics.

And that is the larger picture Americans need to see. This is not only about LGBT policy. It is part of a much broader left-wing push to make dissent costly in every arena: schools, business, medicine, foster care, media, and now the counseling office. The pattern is familiar. First, disagreement is labeled dangerous. Then conscience is labeled discrimination. Then freedom is narrowed until only one moral viewpoint is legally safe.

Colorado is not trying to create a free society. It is trying to create a compliant one.

Christian counselors should not have to choose between their license and their faith. Parents should not have to fear the state if they want biblically grounded help for their children. And clients who are actively asking for counseling aligned with their convictions should not be told by politicians, "No--you may only receive the kind of therapy we approve."

That is not healthcare. That is ideological colonization.

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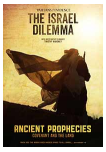

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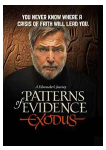

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